



Maria Magdalena Stan

ASSOCIATE PROFESSOR | EDUCATIONAL SCIENCES AND PSYCHOLOGY

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

University lecturer and researcher in psychology and educational sciences, with experience in academic leadership, teacher education, career counselling and guidance, and research project coordination. Director of the Department of Educational Sciences and of the ProEd Expert Research Centre.

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

Associate Professor since 2015 · Department Director since 2020 · ProEd Expert Director since 2015 · PhD in Psychology · Teacher trainer and licensed psychologist

PERSONAL DETAILS

Nationality: Romanian

ACADEMIC IDENTIFIER

ORCID

0000-0002-9944-6832

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Educational psychology · Educational sciences · Early childhood education · Academic adjustment · Inclusive education · Career counselling and guidance

LANGUAGES

Romanian (native) · English · French

DIGITAL SKILLS

Microsoft Office · SPSS

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Oct 2015–present | Associate Professor

National University of Science and Technology POLITEHNICA Bucharest, Pitești University Centre — Teaching courses, seminars and practical classes in psychology and educational sciences at bachelor's and master's level; scientific research and institutional development.

Oct 2012–Oct 2015 | Lecturer

University of Pitești, Faculty of Educational Sciences — Teaching, research and institutional development.

Mar 2006–Sep 2012 | Assistant Professor

University of Pitești, Faculty of Educational Sciences — Seminars and practical classes in psychology and educational sciences; research and institutional development.

Oct 2003–Feb 2006 | Junior Lecturer

University of Pitești, Faculty of Educational Sciences — Seminars and practical classes; research and institutional development.

Oct 2008–Sep 2011 | Associate Teaching Assistant

University of Bucharest, Faculty of Psychology and Educational Sciences — Seminars in Introduction to Psychology, Psychology of Behavioural Stimulation and Regulation, and Educational Psychology; doctoral research and scientific discussions.

Oct 2020–present | Director, Department of Educational Sciences

POLITEHNICA Bucharest, Pitești University Centre / University of Pitești — Department operations; research, quality and financial management; study-plan implementation; academic and research staffing plans.

May 2015–Oct 2020 | Director, Career Counselling and Guidance Centre

University of Pitești — Designed strategy and action plans, coordinated counselling and career guidance, and prepared activity reports.

2015–present | Director, ProEd Expert Research Centre

POLITEHNICA Bucharest, Pitești University Centre / University of Pitești — Leads research teams of faculty, students and school-sector specialists; initiates research projects and partnerships; organises scientific events and disseminates findings for educational practice.

Feb 2024–present | Master's field coordinator; professional conversion and continuing teacher education programme lead

POLITEHNICA Bucharest / University of Pitești — Coordinates Educational Sciences master's programmes and teacher conversion/continuing education. Prepares self-evaluation and quality documentation, procedures, schedules and teaching plans; coordinates trainers and learners, graduation examinations, and programme evaluation.

2026–present | Partner Coordinator, ERASMUS-EDU-2025-PEX-TEACH-ACA

The Academy of Digitally Sustainable European Teacher (DigiSET), project 101249272 — Partner coordination.

2023–2026 | Partner Coordinator, ERASMUS+ KA220-SCH

Promotive Inclusive Instruction for Active Participation in Diverse Classrooms (PIVOT), 2023-1-CY01-KA220-SCH-000156593 — Partner coordination.

2022–2023 | Grant Director, Internal Scientific Research Projects Competition (CIPCS 2021)

University of Pitești — Developed and validated a model for building scientific research competence among master's students (EVMFCS).

2017–2021 | Grant Director, University Grant Scheme

University of Pitești — Romania Secondary Education Project (ROSE), “Start in your career! – Start UPIT”, contract AG 67/SGU/NC/I.

2022–present | Researcher

Transilvania University of Brașov — Research on employed students and the predictive role of job demands and resources in academic adjustment and career adaptability (2025–2028); and on cognitive and non-cognitive predictors of first-year students' adjustment and dropout risk (2022–2024).

2013–2014 | Psychology Researcher (COR 263415)

Danimated Studio SRL — Intelligent and Interactive System for Learning Calligraphic Writing (ATIBo), SMIS 47514, contract 578/12.09.2013.

2007–2009 | Research Grant Team Member

University of Pitești — CAMED, CNCIS 1157 – Quality in Educational Mentoring.

2007–2008 | Research Assistant

University of Maryland, Department of Human Development, Child Development Lab — Bucharest Early Intervention Project, National Institute of Mental Health programme MH56193, coordinated by Nathan A. Fox.

2008–present | Member of project implementation teams

POLITEHNICA Bucharest, Pitești University Centre / University of Pitești — European projects: TeachDiln, The School 4 The Schools, SHE CHOOSES STEM, TOFIE, Flashmind, CLIL4EU, WILD!, LIDO, EN.GA.G.E., Train the Provider, MOOC-DYS, PINECL and ARTIT. Structural funds: SU-ETIC, PROF, ETIC, MSC-EDU, PISA, Competențe pentru cariera ta!, national high-school curriculum restructuring, and Totta Vitae Schola Est. ROSE projects: ING-PIM and Voi fi inginer! PHARE projects: CALED 1 and CALED 2.

Jan 2024–present | External Evaluator, Administrative Sciences, Education and Psychology Commission

ARACIS, Romanian Agency for Quality Assurance in Higher Education — Evaluates the quality of higher education programmes in Educational Sciences.

Nov 2022–present | Academic Panel Member, Specialised Accreditation Commission (CSA)

Directorate-General for Human Resources Management and School Network, Ministry of Education and Research — Evaluates, endorses and awards transferable professional credits to continuing education programmes for pre-university teaching staff.

Nov 2011–Dec 2013 | Project Assistant Manager, POSDRU/19/1.3/G/40784, Totta Vitae Schola Est

University of Pitești — Liaised between project management, finance, legal staff and experts; coordinated communications with authorities, support departments and partners; prepared detailed implementation plans and supporting documentation, timesheets and payment records; developed summer-school and continuing education curricula.

May 2013–Dec 2015 | Activity Implementation Coordination Expert, POSDRU/156/1.2/G/140570, Competențe pentru cariera ta!

University of Pitești — Liaised between project management, authorities, support units, experts and beneficiaries; gathered and communicated activity data; identified implementation requirements, priorities and resources to deliver activities on time.

Oct 2004–present | Teacher Trainer

POLITEHNICA Bucharest / University of Pitești; Argeș Teacher Training Centre; Transilvania University of Brașov; Momentul Critic Association — Designs and delivers continuing professional development for pre-university teachers. Training areas include primary and early childhood education, mentoring and coaching, inclusive education, classroom communication, curriculum, educational management, motivation and socio-emotional skills.

Dec 2010–present | Psychologist

Collaborative practice — Professional authorisations: supervising psychologist and autonomous senior psychologist in educational psychology and school/vocational counselling; autonomous practising psychologist in work psychology; supervised practising psychologist in transport psychology.

2016 | Psychological Counsellor, AG-GUIDING-CAREER (CNFIS-FDI-2016-0037)

University of Pitești — Provided information, psychological and educational counselling, and career guidance to Argeș pupils to support equitable and socially inclusive access to higher education.

Nov 2003–Oct 2006 | Human Resources Consultant

Pluri Consultants; Palmer Consult; Nelsim Construct — Developed HR strategy; designed job analyses and descriptions, recruitment, selection and performance evaluation procedures; implemented compensation and benefits; contributed to organisational development policies and managed allocated budgets.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

Oct 2008–Sep 2011 | PhD in Psychology (awarded under Ministerial Order 3639/27 March 2012)

Doctoral School of Psychology, Faculty of Psychology and Educational Sciences, University of Bucharest

Oct 2007–Sep 2008 | Postgraduate Specialisation Programme in Early Childhood Education

Faculty of Educational Sciences, University of Bucharest

Oct 2003–Jun 2005 | MA in Organisational and Economic Psychology

Faculty of Educational Sciences, University of Bucharest

Oct 1999–Jun 2003 | BA in Psychology

University of Bucharest, Faculty of Psychology and Educational Sciences

Oct 2010–Jul 2013 | Bachelor's Degree in Educational Sciences

Spiru Haret University, Faculty of Psychology and Education Sciences

Sep 2016–Jan 2017 | GCDF Career Consultant; Career Guidance Counsellor (COR 242306)

NBCC Romania

Oct 1994–Jun 1999 | Baccalaureate Diploma, Primary Teacher–Educator specialisation

Carol I Pedagogical College, Câmpulung Muscel

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS AND ACTIVITIES

Languages: Romanian – native; English – listening C1, reading B2, spoken interaction B1, spoken production B1, writing B1; French – listening B2, reading B2, spoken interaction B1, spoken production B1, writing B1.

Scientific reviewer: Frontiers in Psychology; British Educational Research Journal; Cogent Education; Revista de Psihologie; Editura Universitară.

Professional associations: Romanian Psychologists' Association; College of Psychologists of Romania.

Digital skills: Microsoft Office; SPSS.

Driving licence: Category B.

15 September 2026